Era 22: Late Cold War & Conservative Resurgence

1980–1991 · APUSH Period 9 · Lessons 54–54

Name _____ Due _____

This is your study guide for the whole era. Complete each lesson section as you study it, using your class notes and textbook: read the AP topic(s) listed for the lesson in your textbook, define every term, person and event in your own words, then answer the Key Question in 3–5 sentences with specific evidence. Each lesson is checked and stamped in class; the whole guide is collected and graded at the end of the era. **Before the end-of-era test:** finish the Era Wrap-Up, then reread the whole guide. Fix or add anything in a different color.

Lesson 54 *New Right · Reaganomics · end of the*

9.2 (LO B): Explain the causes and effects of continuing policy debates about the role of the federal government over time.
9.3 (LO C): Explain the causes and effects of the end of the Cold War and its legacy.

Read (AP topics in your textbook): Topic 9.2 *Reagan and Conservatism* · Topic 9.3 *The End of the Cold War*

STAMP

Terms

Define it in your own words and explain why it matters.

1. **New Right**

2. **Moral Majority (Jerry Falwell)**

3. **Reaganomics (supply-side economics)**

4. **deregulation**

5. **Strategic Defense Initiative ("Star Wars")**

6. **Reagan Doctrine**

7. **"Evil Empire"**

8. **glasnost & perestroika**

People

Who they were and why they matter.

9. **Ronald Reagan**

10. **Mikhail Gorbachev**

11. **George H.W. Bush**

12. **Sandra Day O'Connor**

13. **Margaret Thatcher**

Events

What happened and why it matters.

14. **Iran Hostage Crisis (1979–81)**

15. **Economic Recovery Tax Act (1981)**

16. **Iran-Contra affair (1986–87)**

17. **"Tear down this wall" speech (1987)**

18. **INF Treaty (1987)**

19. **Berlin Wall falls (1989)**

20. **Soviet Union dissolves (1991)**

Lesson 54 · Key Question *New Right · Reaganomics · end of the*

9.2 (LO B): Explain the causes and effects of continuing policy debates about the role of the federal government over time.
9.3 (LO C): Explain the causes and effects of the end of the Cold War and its legacy.

Explain how the conservative resurgence of the 1980s changed federal economic policy and how U.S.–Soviet relations changed as the Cold War came to an end.

Answer in 3–5 sentences. Make a clear claim, support it with at least two specific pieces of evidence from this lesson, and explain how the evidence supports your claim.

Era Wrap-Up *complete before the end-of-era test*

Reagan's Agenda

Policy	What it did	Supporters' argument	Critics' argument
Economic Recovery Tax Act (1981)			
Deregulation			
Defense buildup & SDI			
Reagan Doctrine			

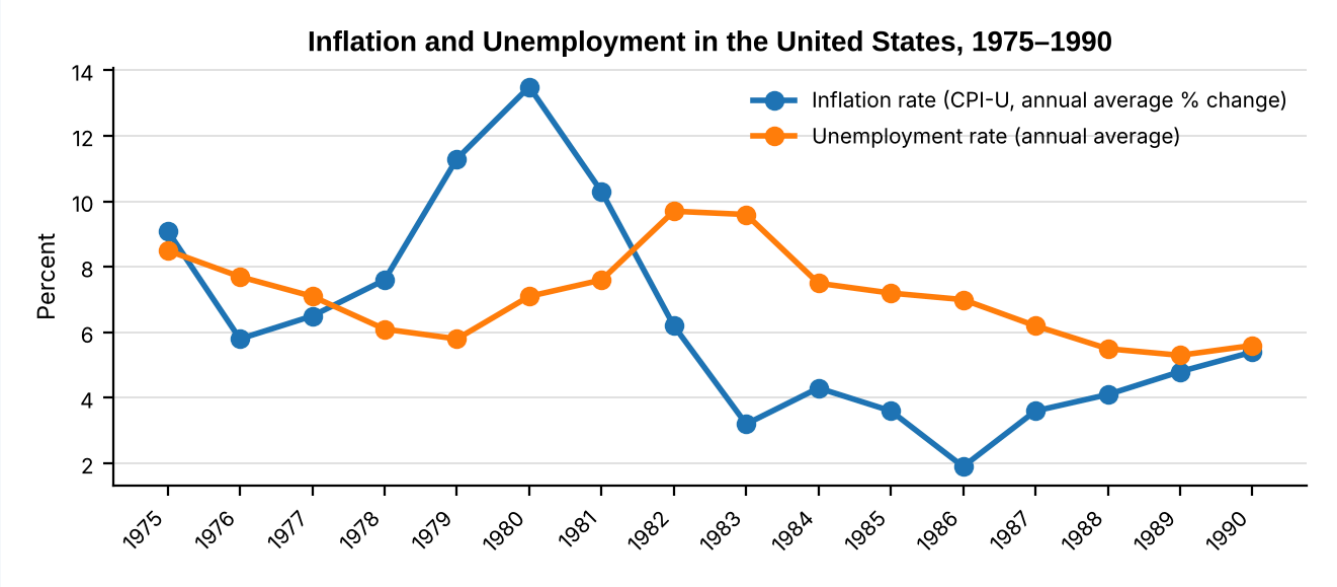
How the Cold War Ended

Development	What happened	Why it mattered
Glasnost & perestroika (Gorbachev)		
INF Treaty (1987)		
Fall of the Berlin Wall (1989)		
Dissolution of the Soviet Union (1991)		

AP Short-Answer Practice

Answer a, b and c. Each part is scored on its own, so answer each one directly in 1–3 sentences with specific historical evidence.

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers (CPI-U) and Current Population Survey annual averages, 1975–1990



Inflation = percent change in the annual-average CPI-U from the previous year. Unemployment = percent of the civilian labor force, annual average.

Data: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Historical CPI-U table (U.S. city average, all items) and Current Population Survey, Table 1 (annual averages).

a. Briefly describe ONE trend in inflation OR unemployment shown in the chart between 1975 and 1990.

b. Briefly explain ONE cause of the economic conditions shown in the chart for the late 1970s.

c. Briefly explain ONE way federal economic policy changed in the 1980s in response to conditions like those shown in the chart.

DBQ Practice · Contextualization

PROMPT

Evaluate the extent to which Ronald Reagan's presidency changed the role of the federal government in the U.S. economy from 1981 to 1989.

Your task: Write a contextualization paragraph (3–4 sentences) that you could use to open an essay on this prompt. The document on this page and the chart on the AP Short-Answer page may help.

What earns the point: To earn the point, describe a broader historical context relevant to the prompt: developments before, during, or continuing after 1981–1989 (for example, 1970s stagflation or the rise of the New Right). Explain how that context connects to the topic; a single phrase or reference is not enough.

Ronald Reagan, Inaugural Address, Washington, D.C., January 20, 1981

These United States are confronted with an economic affliction of great proportions. We suffer from the longest and one of the worst sustained inflations in our national history. It distorts our economic decisions, penalizes thrift, and crushes the struggling young and the fixed-income elderly alike. It threatens to shatter the lives of millions of our people.

[. . .]

In this present crisis, government is not the solution to our problem; government is the problem. From time to time we've been tempted to believe that society has become too complex to be managed by self-rule, that government by an elite group is superior to government for, by, and of the people. Well, if no one among us is capable of governing himself, then who among us has the capacity to govern someone else?

Text: The American Presidency Project, UC Santa Barbara (from Public Papers of the Presidents). Excerpt.

Connect forward — *Era 23 preview: with the Soviet Union gone, the United States was the world's only superpower. How would it define its role abroad without a Cold War rival, and how would the debate over the size of government continue?*